English Idioms

What are idioms? Among other things it is a group of words that give a figurative meaning.

It is an expression whose meaning cannot be traced to the individual words. They are also inflexible.

Match the following idioms with their meanings:

1. To have an axe to grind
2. An apple of discord
3. The acid test
4. Black hole of Calcutta
5. On cloud nine
6. Bob is your uncle
7. To pass the buck
8. To keep fingers crossed
9. As the crow flies
10. The last straw

Meanings

a. to sidestep responsibility
b. cramped airless condition
c. in a state of elation
d. Something that causes disagreement
e. to have a secret motive
f. the shortest distance between two places
g. everything turns out well
h. a foolproof assessment
i. to hope for a good outcome
j. seemingly minor action that causes an unpleasant reaction